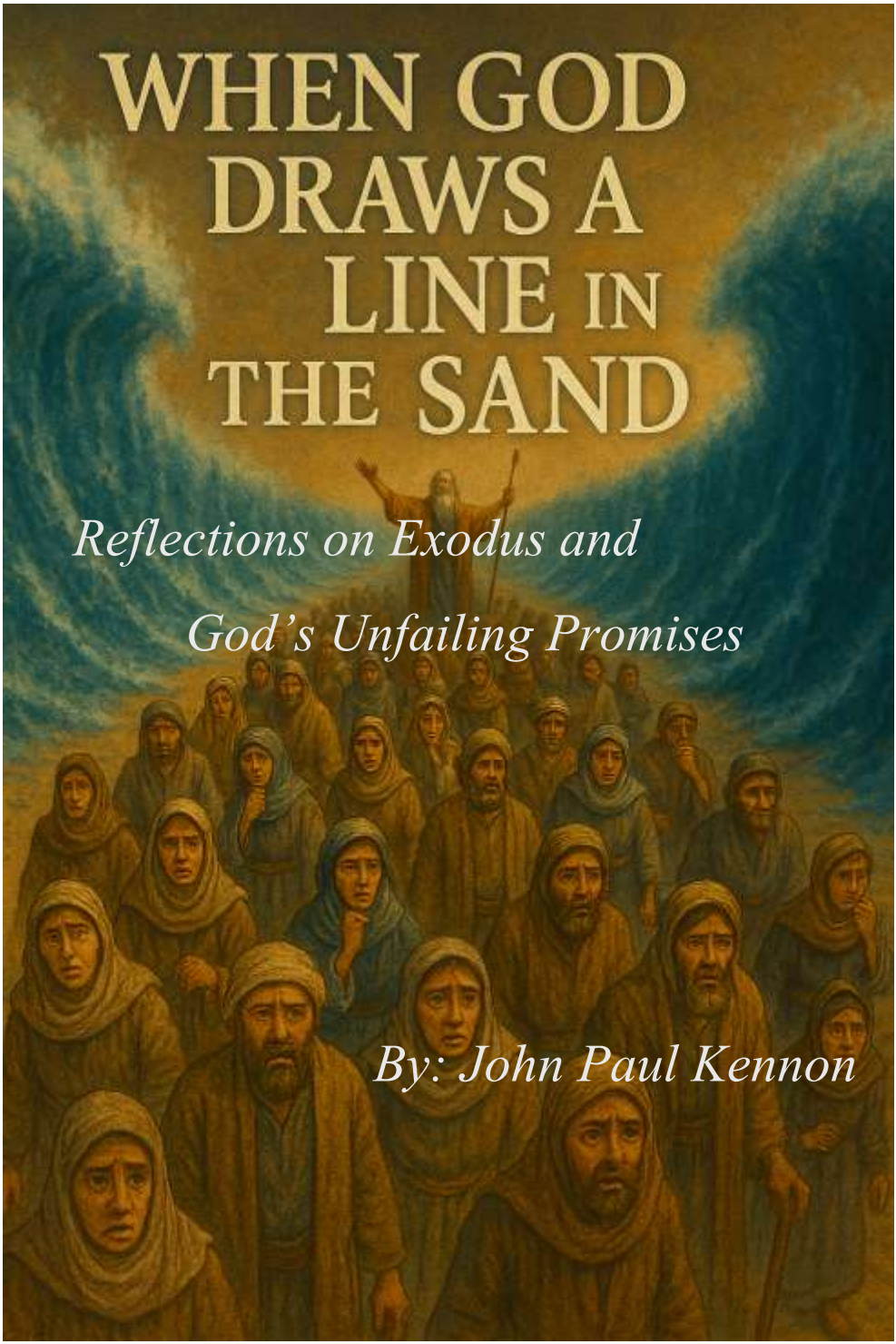

WHEN GOD DRAWS A LINE IN THE SAND
Reflections on Exodus and God's Unfailing Promises
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INTRODUCTION

Have you ever imagined that God draws lines in the sand? Recall the story of the woman caught in adultery—thrust before Jesus as He knelt to write in the dust. We don't know His exact words, but we see the seismic impact: one act shattering oppressive rules, transforming her destiny, and leaving onlookers stunned. Even two thousand years later, that moment resonates with profound power. This was a line in the sand proverbially speaking, directly in front of their path. Daring the naysayers to cross, protecting the one forgiven.

Now consider a solitary line traced across the sand: steadfast and unmistakable, charged with meaning for all who pause to observe. If we journey further back, to the book of Exodus, we find God Himself carving lines that delivered hope to entire nations. Those lines changed the course of millions, echoing through generations, and remain today among one of the most celebrated victories in history. This was a line in the sand drawn as a path forward. A path of deliverance, hope and destiny. A way of escape from oppression, tyranny and slave masters. A way to advance forward in life and leave the past behind. Such is the beauty and power when God draws a line—clear, purposeful, eternal, and endlessly impactful.

Here's a description of various types of lines and their impacts:

1. Boundary Lines:

Effect: These lines create clear limits, providing safety and security. They protect what is within by defining what is without.

Affect: Establishing boundaries helps individuals and societies maintain order and prevent conflict. They teach us respect for others' spaces and rights.

2. Guiding Lines:

Effect: These lines act like maps, steering us in a specific direction with purpose and intent. They offer clarity in navigation and decision-making.

Affect: Guiding lines inspire confidence and motivation, giving us a sense of direction. They can help us achieve goals and fulfill our potential.

3. Dividing Lines:

Effect: These lines create divisions, highlighting differences and setting opposing sides apart.

Affect: They can lead to conflict, rivalry, or competition if not managed wisely. They may also foster uniqueness and identity within defined groups.

4. Threshold Lines:

Effect: Represent moments of transition or change, symbolizing moving from one state or place to another.

Affect: Crossing threshold lines can be empowering, marking the beginning of new chapters or opportunities. They are moments of courage and growth.

5. Connecting Lines:

Effect: These lines bridge gaps, linking people, places, or ideas into a coherent whole.

Affect: Connecting lines build unity and understanding, fostering relationships and collaboration. They bring together disparate elements into harmony.

6. Imaginary Lines:

Effect: While not physically present, these lines exist in minds or societies, shaping beliefs, strategies, or lifestyles.

Affect: Imaginary lines can drive innovation and creativity by encouraging thinking outside the box. They may also unlock potential through ideals and dreams.

Overall Impact:

Lines delineate our world, offering structure and meaning. While their effect provides a framework or blueprint, their effect deeply influences emotions, behaviors, and interactions. They

teach us about balance—between freedom and restriction, individualism and community, change and stability. Recognizing and respecting these lines enriches our lives, guiding us in creating paths that reflect who we are within the shared landscape of humanity.

Biblical Example of Restrictive Lines:

The Ten Commandments etched in stone, guiding Israelites with divine boundaries.

Real-World Parallel:

Traffic lights glow red, stopping chaos and ensuring order on bustling city streets.

Biblical Example of Guiding Lines:

"Thy word is a lamp unto my feet," leading believers through life's uncertainties with hope.

Real-World Parallel:

Trail markers on a hiking path, steering adventurers safely through the woods.

Contrasting Statements:

Restrictive lines draw a boundary; guiding lines draw a map.

Boundaries hold us steady; pathways propel us forward.

Lines in the sand warn of danger; lines on the path promise direction.

Rules bind us for protection; principles lead us to purpose.

By examining both restrictive and guiding lines, we find balance in order and progress, equally essential in our lives. Lines serve as essential framework establishing order, delineating boundaries, and shaping cohesive design and function.

Determining which line is in front of you will determine how you respond in faith. There is no doubting God uses lines to establish great character in believers.

This book is about lines of deliverance laid out in front of us drawn out by the hand of God and prayed down from heaven into earth. Ultimately into your mind, your plans, your daily thoughts, and your hopes dreams and aspirations. God has a line drawn. Its up to you to choose to follow.

CHAPTER 1 - God's Faithful Covenant

Exodus 2:24-25 (paraphrased)
God heard Israel's groaning. He remembered His covenant with Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob.
He looked upon them and had respect for them.

From the very beginning, **God remembers**. It doesn't matter how dire the circumstances, how heavy the burdens, or how loud the enemy's threats. When the Lord says He will do something, He will do it in **His** timing and **His** way. He is the omniscient One—there is no darkness too thick, no distance too far, no foe too great.

Compare and contrast a human promise—fleeting, sometimes broken, subject to change—and God's covenant—unbreakable, unstoppable, anchored by His eternal faithfulness. The difference is night and day.

Here are three everyday snapshots to illustrate how **human promises** can fade like morning mist, while **God's covenant** remains as unshakable as a mountain:

1. **Wedding Vows vs. God's Rainbow**

Human Promise: Two people stand at the altar, pledging to love and cherish "till death do us part." Yet sometimes, years later, one decides they've had enough and walks away. The vow—once sealed with tears and celebration—dissolves in heartbreak.

God's Covenant: Contrast that with the rainbow sign in Genesis. After the flood, God promised He would never again destroy the world with water, and He sealed it with the shimmering arc in the sky. Thousands of years later, every time the storm clouds clear, that rainbow still whispers, "My promise stands."

2. **Political Promises vs. The Abrahamic Covenant**

Human Promise: Politicians pound podiums during campaign season, promising lower taxes, perfect roads, and a chicken in every pot. But after election day, reality sets in—budgets shift, new advisors come into play, and those grand promises can get shoved into the background.

God's Covenant: When God spoke to Abraham, He vowed to make his descendants as countless as the stars, bless the entire world through him, and give him a land of promise. Even when Abraham's descendants were unfaithful, God's plan kept unfolding. Empires rose and fell around Israel, yet the Lord's covenant thread wove continuously through history.

3. **Casual "I've Got Your Back" vs. Jesus' "Never Leave You"**

Human Promise: A friend might say, "Hey, I've got your back, I'll be there," but then they forget your birthday, ghost you in tough times, or make excuses when you need real help. We're all human, and sometimes life just gets messy, busy, or complicated.

God's Covenant: On the other hand, Jesus declares, *"I will never leave you nor forsake you."* It's not a flimsy sentiment; it's a promise backed by the cross and resurrection. When everyone else scatters, He remains faithful—present in hospital rooms, lonely apartments, and broken hearts.

In every case, human promises—though often sincere at first—can bend under pressure, fade with time, or crumble under disappointment. But God's covenant is anchored in His unchanging character. No matter how many storms blow in, His faithfulness remains, and His words stand forever. That's why we can hold tight to Him even when the rest of the world wobbles.

God's Liberating Promise

Exodus 6:6
"I am the LORD, and I will bring you out from under the burdens of the Egyptians…"

God draws a line in the sand for His people, declaring, "Enough is enough." When Israel could no longer carry the weight of Egyptian bondage, the Lord promised deliverance.

Compare and contrast your own efforts—limited, frustrated, exhausted—and God's outstretched arm—unlimited, unstoppable, ready to break every chain. Where we are finite, He is infinite. Where we break, He remains unbroken.

1. **Trying to Fix Our Finances vs.**

   God's Miraculous Provision

   Human Effort: We budget, pinch pennies, juggle credit cards, and still find ourselves short at the end of the month. The anxiety of bills piling up can wear us thin—our best-laid plans feel like a cracked jar that just won't hold water.

   God's Outstretched Arm: Then comes a divine open door: an unexpected promotion, a timely gift, or the calm conviction that He's going to make ends meet in a way we never saw coming. Where our spreadsheets and hustle break down, His provision abounds.

2. **Breaking an Addiction vs. God's Delivering Power**

   Human Effort: We white-knuckle it, remove every temptation from the house, read self-help books, and schedule accountability calls, only to slip back into old habits. Our will feels like it's running on fumes.

   God's Outstretched Arm: Yet the moment we turn our desperation into surrender, God steps in with supernatural grace. Support appears from unexpected places. That chain we couldn't break alone suddenly snaps under the weight of His power. In our weakness, He shows Himself strong.

3. **Healing a Broken Relationship vs.**

God's Restorative Hand

Human Effort: We text, we call, we try to patch things up. But bitterness clings, harsh words echo, and reconciliation feels out of reach. Everything we do seems to open more wounds.

God's Outstretched Arm: Then God nudges us to forgive deeper than we thought we could. He softens hearts—sometimes ours, sometimes theirs—leading to tears, apologies, and the start of real healing. Where we break under the strain, His boundless love works miracles.

In each of these, our resources run dry fast; His never do. We reach the end of ourselves, but He's only begun. Our **finite** efforts can crack under pressure, yet His **infinite** grace, power, and faithfulness hold firm. It's not that our efforts have no value—God often uses our perseverance and intention—but ultimately, He does the heavy lifting. Where we let go, He takes over. Where we are weak, He is eternally unbroken.

Standing at the Red Sea

Exodus 14:10-16 (highlights)
Israel saw the Egyptians marching after them and were very afraid…
Moses said, "Fear not, stand still, and see the salvation of the LORD…"
Then the LORD said, "Lift up your rod… and the children of Israel shall go on dry ground."

At the edge of the Red Sea, fear pressed in, doubts rose, and escape seemed impossible. **Yet God drew a line in the sand**—actually, in the water. He made a way forward that only He could create.

A Line That Protects

- The waters parted, forming walls on either side, a path for the people of God.
- **Contrast**: For the Egyptians, this same line in the sand became a trap. Israel crossed; Egypt drowned.

A Line That Propels

- God often puts a line in front of us that isn't just a boundary; it's an invitation to "go forward."
- **Compare** standing still in paralyzing fear *versus* stepping into the parted waters with bold trust. One choice leads to stagnation; the other leads to supernatural rescue.

A Line That Protects

Example: Parting the Red Sea (Exodus 14)

- **Protection for Israel:**
  God parts the Red Sea, creating towering walls of water on both sides—like a hallway of divine protection. Israel steps onto the seabed and crosses over on dry ground. They walk in awe, shielded from their would-be captors.

  Destruction for Egypt:
  That very same corridor becomes a trap for the Egyptian army. When they pursue Israel into the sea, the waters collapse and drown them. What was a miraculous *refuge* for God's people becomes total *ruin* for the enemy.

Key Contrast:

- *Israel:* Obediently steps onto God's path and finds deliverance.
- *Egypt:* Pridefully marches onto God's path and finds destruction.
- God's "line" here acts like a shield—an impenetrable barrier around His children. He proves He is both the Defender of the faithful and the Judge of the oppressor.

End of sample

Thank you for reading the opening of When God Draws a Line in the Sand.

The full edition is being prepared for publication.

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